

Sowilo rune is stigmatized pt2

Sowilō (or Sowilo) is the reconstructed Proto-Germanic name of the 16th rune in the Elder Futhark, representing the 'S' sound and symbolizing the sun, energy, victory, and success. Resembling a lightning bolt (𐌺, 𐌽), it signifies positive energy, vitality, and wholeness in divination, representing a time of achievement and clarity. [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

Key Aspects of the Sowilō Rune:

- **Meaning:** Directly translates to "sun" and is associated with strength, success, and high energy.
- **Symbolism:** Represents power, fertility, and the radiant, life-giving force of the sun.
- **Usage:** Often viewed as a "victory" rune, used to gain power and motivation.
- **Appearances:** It is found in all three rune poems (Old Norse, Old English, and Gothic) and is generally shaped like a zigzag, similar to a modern "S" or a lightning bolt.
- **Divination:** In its upright position, it indicates success and optimal health; in an inverted (shadow) position, it can suggest a need to avoid destructive tendencies or selfishness. [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

The rune's shape is derived from the Old Italic 's' (sigma), and it is sometimes referred to by other names, including *Sol* or *Sigel*. [1, 2]

Yes, the **Sowilo rune (𐌺)** is stigmatized in the modern world due to its appropriation by Nazi Germany.

- The **Schutzstaffel (SS)**, a major paramilitary organization of the Nazi Party, used a logo of two **Sowilo runes** side-by-side (𐌺𐌺), known as the "SS bolts" or "lightning bolts." This symbol became an emblem of Nazi ideology, victory, and a criminal organization responsible for atrocities.
- As a result, the Sowilo rune, especially in its double form, is now strongly associated with Nazism, white supremacy, and far-right extremism. It is considered a hate symbol when used in this context and is banned or restricted in several European countries (like Germany) when used to promote Nazi ideology.
- However, within modern pagan, Heathen, and historical linguistic communities, the Sowilo rune is reclaimed for its original meaning, which is the **sun** (*sōwilō*), representing light, vitality, success, and spiritual growth. Practitioners emphasize its ancient, pre-Nazi significance.

The symbol's meaning is therefore highly dependent on **context**. Its use requires awareness of its controversial history.

The character commonly referred to as the "Sowilo emoji" is technically the **Runic Letter Sowilo S** (symbol: 𐌺 or 𐌽). It is not a true emoji in the Unicode standard, but a letter within the **Runic** block, with the code point **U+16CA**.

- **Unicode Name:** Runic Letter Sowilo S
- **Symbol:** 𐌺

- **Meaning:** The name *Sowilo* (*sōwilō*) reconstructs to mean "**sun**."
- **Historical Names:** In historical rune poems, the rune was known as **Sigel** (Anglo-Saxon) or **Sól** (Old Norse), both also meaning "sun."
- **Usage:** Because it lacks emoji presentation, it often appears as text; users frequently combine it with sun (☀️) or lightning (⚡️) emojis to create a "Sowilo emoji" aesthetic.